

VEU Accredited Person Website Prototype

A scratch-to-production specification for a multi-page marketing website built to stand apart from a generic market — and to evolve as the client reacts.

DEV-FACING · TECHNICAL · v1.0 · PROTOTYPE SCOPE

1 · How to use this document

Read this page first. It explains the status system that runs through the whole PRD and the intent behind how it is written.

This is a specification for a **website prototype**, not a final production sign-off. The goal is a complete, buildable site that the owner and the end client can react to and reshape. Some decisions are locked; others are deliberately left to your creativity within guardrails; a few are still open and await a client call. **Every such point is tagged so nothing is silently assumed.**

The status tag system

✓ **LOCKED**

Decided. Build to this. Changing it is a deliberate decision, not a default. Example: the "you do nothing, we handle the whole chain" positioning.

◆ **DEV'S DISCRETION**

Your call on execution. The goal and guardrails are given; you propose the implementation. Example: the exact visual design direction, the depth of the eligibility checker. Use your judgement and craft.

● **CLIENT TO CONFIRM**

Open input needed. A recommendation is given, but the owner/client must supply or confirm before launch. Use a sensible placeholder in the prototype. Example: brand assets, lead destination, contact details.

◆ **PHASE 2 / PARKED**

Deliberately deferred. Specced enough to add later without a rebuild. Do not build now; architect so it can slot in. Example: the interactive stacking-savings calculator.

◆ Build philosophy — please read

This prototype *will* change. The owner and client expect to add, remove, reorder, and restyle things after seeing it. Build accordingly: **component-based and modular**, so each page section is an independent, swappable block. Favour a clean separation of content from layout. A change to one section, page, or color must never require reworking the whole site. Where this PRD gives you discretion, lean into it — the explicit aim is to **not** look like the templated competitors analysed in Section 4.

Content maintenance model

Decision: ✓ **LOCKED** — **developer-maintained, no CMS.** Content can be statically authored and cleanly organised in the codebase. The owner will route all content changes through the developer. This keeps the prototype simple and fast to stand up; a CMS can be reconsidered in a later phase if volume of edits justifies it.

2 · Project overview & objective

2.1 What is being built

A multi-page marketing website (delivered as a clickable prototype) for a Victorian **Accredited Person (AP)** operating under the **Victorian Energy Upgrades (VEU)** program. The site markets energy-efficiency upgrades (solar, heat pumps, hot water, battery, air conditioning, LED) to two audiences — **residential households** and **commercial & industrial (C&I) businesses** — and converts them into leads.

2.2 Who the client is — and why it matters for the build

The client is a **full-chain Accredited Person**. This is the single most important fact for positioning. Under the VEU program, only an Accredited Person can create the tradable certificates (VEECs) that fund the rebates. This client owns the **entire chain**: lead → site assessment → installation (via their registered installers) → certificate creation → certificate sale. The customer does almost nothing.

✓ **The core positioning the whole site must express**

"We are accredited, and we handle everything end-to-end. You do nothing." This is a stronger, more honest promise than what most competitors make, and the site is built to own it.

✓ LOCKED

2.3 Primary objective

Convert visitors into qualified leads, with a structure that lets each audience self-select quickly. The site supports multiple conversion actions layered by commitment level: **check eligibility** (low friction, primary), **get a quote / book assessment** (higher intent), and **learn / build trust** (for the skeptical researcher).

2.4 Audience model

Audience	Journey character	What they need to feel
Residential	Mostly "deemed" upgrades — fast, upfront discount, simple. Emotional + savings-driven.	"This is legit, it's simple, and I'm not being scammed by a 'FREE' gimmick."
Commercial / C&I	Larger solar projects; can run a longer measurement & verification path. Rational, ROI-driven, slower decision.	"These people are credible, compliant, and will manage a six-figure project properly."

Why a self-select structure is mandatory

A page that speaks equally to a homeowner wanting a heat-pump rebate and a CFO weighing a six-figure solar project speaks clearly to neither. The site must let each visitor **self-identify within the first screen** and route to content, numbers, and CTAs tuned to them. This is enforced in the Home page spec (Section 6).

✓ LOCKED

3 · Domain primer (so the build is accurate)

The developer does not need to be a VEU expert, but the site makes specific factual claims. These must be represented correctly — some are compliance-sensitive.

3.1 How the money actually works

1. A customer installs an eligible upgrade.
2. The AP **creates VEECs** (Victorian Energy Efficiency Certificates) based on the carbon/energy saved. Only an accredited person can do this.
3. The AP **sells those certificates to energy retailers / large emitters** — *not* to the government. Retailers are legally obligated to buy a quota each year, which creates the demand.
4. The certificate value is passed back to the customer as an **upfront discount**. The AP's margin sits in the spread and/or project/install fees.

The government's role

The government creates the *obligation* (forcing retailers to buy certificates) and sets the rules — it is the referee that makes the market exist, not the buyer. The certificate price is set by market supply and demand, not by the government. This nuance is the backbone of the "How It Works" page (Section 6), because **no competitor explains it clearly** — see Section 4.

3.2 Compliance-sensitive facts the site MUST honour

⚠ The "no free upgrades" rule — non-negotiable

There are **no free upgrades** under the VEU program. A provider advertising a completely "free" system is **not complying** with program requirements; a minimum customer contribution applies. **This site must never use the word "free"** in a way that implies zero cost. Several competitors do exactly this — it is a liability, and avoiding it is one of our differentiators (honest pricing). Copy guidance: talk about "a large upfront discount" and "what you'll actually pay," never "free."

⚠ Keep two different programs distinct

The **VEU program** (federal-adjacent state scheme, certificate-based, not means-tested) is different from the **Solar Victoria** rebate (which has income thresholds). Conflating them will mislead users. The site may mention both — and the *stacking* of them is a selling point — but must not blur their rules. Income thresholds belong only to the Solar Victoria component.

3.3 The "stacking" story (a selling point)

Customers can often combine three incentive layers: the **VEU** discount, the **Solar Victoria** rebate (where eligible), and federal **STCs** (Small-scale Technology Certificates). Explaining this combined value clearly is white space no competitor owns well. In v1 this is an **explainer section**; an interactive calculator is parked for Phase 2 (Section 8).

3.4 Trust facts worth using

- Accredited Persons must pass a **"fit and proper persons" test and a "competent and capable" test every year**, and renew accreditation annually. This is a strong, specific credibility signal that **no competitor uses**. Surface it on About / trust sections.
- The VEU program is long-running (since 2009) and its target period has been extended well into the future — useful for "this isn't going away" reassurance.

Note: indicative rebate figures (dollar amounts, percentages) change with policy and market pricing. Treat all such numbers as

- **CLIENT TO CONFIRM**

and always frame them as "up to / indicative." Do not hardcode specific dollar values as guarantees.

4 · Competitive gap analysis (the strategy)

19 competitor AP / energy-upgrade sites were reviewed. They are strikingly generic. This is the opportunity: the site can win at the **website level**, not only on service. Below is what the market does the same, and the specific gaps this site is built to exploit. Each gap maps to a feature later in this PRD.

4.1 What the whole market does identically (the sea of sameness)

Pattern	How widespread	Our response
Green / green-blue eco palette	~16 of 19 — the category looks like one site	Deliberately distinct visual identity (Section 5)
Generic hero ("Save up to 60%", "Say goodbye to bill shock")	Near universal	Hero that owns a <i>position</i> , not a discount number
Identical icon-grid of upgrades (drop/snowflake/battery/bulb)	Most	Allowed, but must be visually re-conceived — not the stock grid
Same stock photos (family on couch, polo-shirt man, roof technician)	Most	Art direction guidance to avoid the stock library look
Vague "Why choose us" 3-pillar block	Most	Replaced with specific, provable trust (accreditation, full-chain)

4.2 Where they fail — our eight openings

① Nobody explains how the money actually works

Only one competitor (Glow Green) attempts the mechanism, buried at the bottom in tiny text. None clearly answer the visitor's real anxiety: "Where does this money come from? What's the catch?" → **We build a dedicated, prominent "How It Works" page.** Biggest single gap.

② The "FREE" trust gap

Several competitors lead with "free" (a non-compliant claim, per Section 3.2). → **We win trust by being honest about cost** — a differentiator *and* a compliance shield.

③ The full-chain story is barely told

Only Glow Green is positioned end-to-end, and even they pitch mostly to installers, not customers. → **Our "you do nothing" promise is the strongest consumer message in the category and almost unclaimed.**

④ The eligibility checker is nearly absent

Of 19 sites, **only one (Energy Matters)** has a real multi-step eligibility quiz — and it's their best, most prominent asset. The other 18 just have "Request a Quote." → **An interactive eligibility checker is our centerpiece** (Section 6, dedicated page).

⑤ Accreditation is underused as proof

Most sites say "accredited" with no evidence. Only two show official badges. The genuinely strong fact — annual fit-and-proper / competent-and-capable testing — is used by **nobody**. → **We make accreditation a visible, evidenced trust weapon.**

⑥ Stacking is never explained well

No competitor clearly lays out VEU + Solar Victoria + STC as a combined total. → **We own the "here's your total combined saving" story** (explainer now, calculator Phase 2).

⑦ **Almost none serve mixed residential + C&I well**

Most are residential-only or single-product (e.g. aircon-only, heat-pump-only). → **Our clean self-select + dedicated business journey serves both**, which the market mostly doesn't.

⑧ **No one has a real C&I story**

Only two sites speak to business/industrial, and dryly. The six-figure commercial solar opportunity is wide open. → **A dedicated, credible Business / C&I page.**

The one-line strategy

Be the **transparent, trustworthy, full-chain** option in a category of vague green lookalikes — and prove it with an eligibility checker, an honest "how the money works" explainer, and visible accreditation. Every page in Section 6 serves this.

5 · Visual & brand direction ◆ DEV'S DISCRETION

The owner has chosen to let the developer/designer propose the visual direction. This is intentional. What follows is a **brief, not a blank** — the goals and guardrails are fixed; the execution is yours.

⚠ Hard guardrails — what to AVOID

Based on the gap analysis, the design must **not** fall into the generic category template:

- Avoid the default "eco green" palette as the primary identity (≈16/19 competitors use it — it reads as generic on arrival).
- Avoid the stock photo library look (family-on-couch, arms-crossed-polo-man, roof-technician).
- Avoid the identical drop/snowflake/battery/bulb icon grid as-is.
- Avoid a hero that leads with a discount number instead of a position.

Qualities to hit (propose a direction that achieves these)

- **Distinctive & recognisably "not them"** — a visitor who has seen five competitor sites should feel this one is different within seconds.
- **Trustworthy & credible** — this brand handles people's money and six-figure projects. The design should feel substantial and legitimate, not leaflet-y.
- **Clear hierarchy** — the self-select and the primary CTA must be unmissable.
- **Works for both audiences** — premium enough for a CFO, approachable enough for a homeowner.

Please propose **2–3 visual directions** (palette, type, hero treatment, one sample section) for the owner to react to before full build. Treat brand assets (logo, final colors, fonts) as ◆ CLIENT TO CONFIRM — use tasteful placeholders until provided.

Responsive & technical baseline ◆

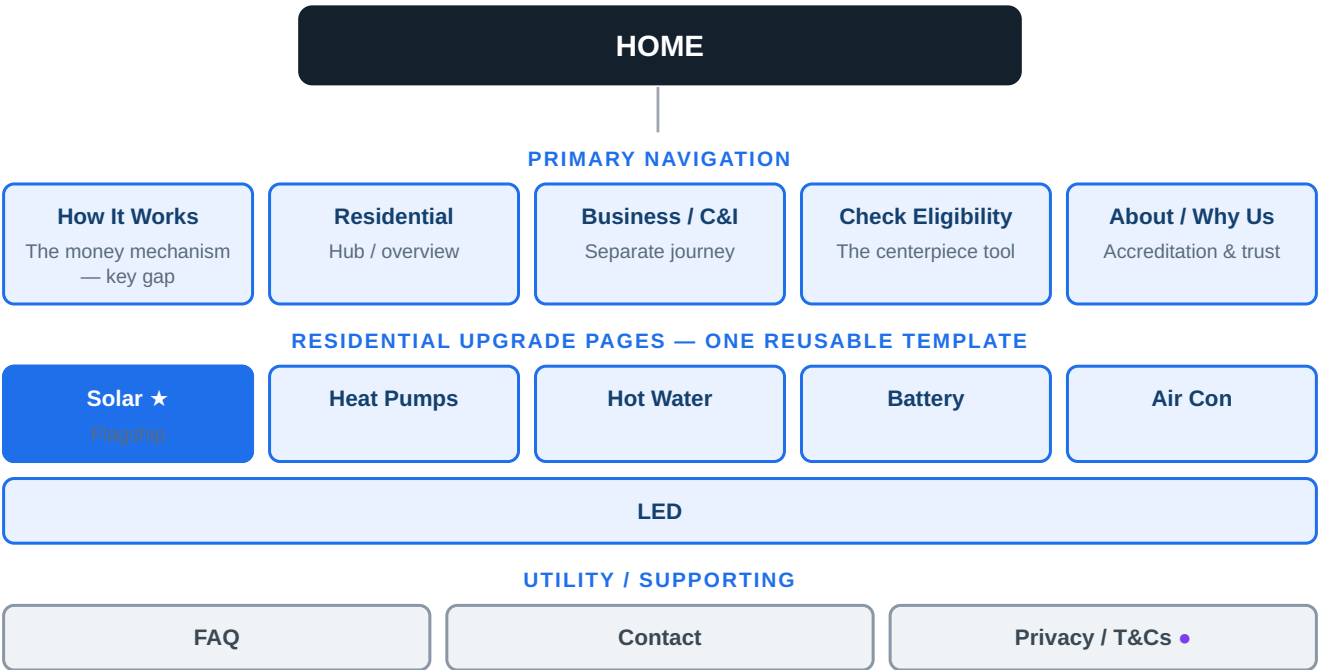
Mobile-first and fully responsive is required (much of this traffic is mobile). Accessibility to a sensible standard (semantic markup, contrast, focus states, alt text). Performance-conscious (fast load, optimised images). Tech stack is the developer's choice ◆ CLIENT TO CONFIRM if a preference exists — a component-based framework is recommended to satisfy the modularity requirement in Section 1.

6 · Site architecture

The full site map is below, followed by page-by-page specifications. Upgrade types use separate pages built from one reusable template, so any upgrade can be added, edited, or removed independently.

✓ LOCKED structure — individual pages can still be dropped/reordered per the modular principle.

6.1 Sitemap



Page	Role	Status
Home	Self-select hub; teases every key section; primary conversion surface	✓
How It Works	Transparent VEEC → retailer → discount explainer (gap ①)	✓
Residential (hub)	Overview of household upgrades; routes to upgrade pages	✓
Solar (flagship)	Lead upgrade page; richest of the template instances; feeds C&I	✓
Heat Pumps / Hot Water / Battery / Air Con / LED	Templated upgrade pages, reusing one pattern	✓ set ·  which ship in v1
Business / C&I	Dedicated commercial journey — ROI/credibility framed (gap ⑥)	✓
Check Eligibility	Interactive checker + lead capture (gap ④, centerpiece)	✓ · depth 
About / Why Us	Accreditation-as-proof, full-chain story (gaps ③ ⑤)	✓
FAQ		✓

	Resolves doubts; pre-answered questions provided below	
Contact	Direct contact + form	✓ · details •
Privacy / T&Cs	Legal pages	• client to provide copy

◆ **Global elements (build once, reuse everywhere)**

Header/nav (with a persistent primary CTA — "Check Eligibility"), **footer** (contact, accreditation badges, nav, legal), a reusable **lead-capture form component** (used by Eligibility, Contact, and inline CTAs), a **trust-badge strip**, and a **sticky mobile call/CTA bar**. Building these as shared components is what makes the site cheap to change later.

7 · Page-by-page specification

Each card lists the page's job, its section blocks (in order), the headline/CTA intent (not final copy — owner chose headlines/CTAs only), and notes. Body copy is to be drafted separately. Blocks are modular and reorderable.

7.1 · Home ✓ LOCKED

The most important page. Must let both audiences self-select fast and tease every key story.

SECTION BLOCKS (IN ORDER)

1. **Hero** — owns a position (e.g. "The accredited team that handles your entire energy upgrade — start to rebate"). Primary CTA: *Check your eligibility*. Secondary: *Get a quote*. Avoid leading with a discount %.
2. **Audience self-select** — two clear paths: "I'm a homeowner" / "I'm a business". Routes to Residential vs Business. **This is the single most important block on the page.**
3. **How the money works (teaser)** — 3–4 step visual; links to full How It Works page. Headline intent: "Why this isn't too good to be true."
4. **Full-chain "you do nothing"** — the 4-step We assess → We install → We handle paperwork → You save.
5. **Upgrades** — entry tiles to the upgrade pages (re-conceived, not the stock icon grid).
6. **Stacking explainer** — VEU + Solar Victoria + STC combined value (no calculator in v1; leave a slot).
7. **Trust / accreditation strip** — badges + the annual fit-and-proper testing fact.
8. **Social proof** — reviews/testimonials • client to supply.
9. **FAQ teaser** — 4–5 top questions; links to full FAQ.
10. **Final CTA + contact.**

NOTES

Layered CTAs, not four equal buttons competing. "Check eligibility" is primary throughout. Each block is an independent component so the owner can reorder/remove after review.

7.2 · How It Works ✓ LOCKED

Our #1 market gap. The transparency play. Make it genuinely clear and confident.

SECTION BLOCKS

1. **The plain-English mechanism** — install → AP creates VEECs → sold to retailers (not govt) → value returned to you as upfront discount. A clear step diagram.
2. **"Where does the money come from?"** — the obligated-retailer market explained simply. Kills the "what's the catch" anxiety.
3. **"Why it isn't "free""** — honest cost framing (compliance + trust, per Section 3.2).
4. **The stacking explainer** — the three incentive layers (full version of the home teaser).
5. **Timelines** — what to expect, residential (fast) vs C&I (longer M&V path).
6. **CTA** — into eligibility checker.

NOTES

A diagram here adds real value ◆ (consider an animated/step-through). This page is a key differentiator — give it craft, not a wall of text.

7.3 · Check Eligibility

✓ centerpiece

◆ depth

18 of 19 competitors lack this. It is our conversion engine and doubles as lead capture.

TWO IMPLEMENTATION TIERS — PICK BY EFFORT, KNOW THE TARGET

Tier A (minimum): a short qualifying form — location (Victoria?), property type, home or business, which upgrade(s) of interest, contact details — ending in a "you likely qualify, we'll be in touch" result + lead capture.

Tier B (target): a branching multi-step quiz that adapts questions to earlier answers (e.g. business vs home forks into different paths) and returns a *tailored* result (relevant upgrades + indicative — never guaranteed — value), then captures the lead.

Build at least Tier A for the prototype; architect so it can grow into Tier B without a rewrite. Reference benchmark: Energy Matters' quiz is the strongest asset in the entire competitor set — we should match and exceed it.

NOTES

Indicative values shown must be framed "up to / indicative" . Lead destination (CRM/email/booking) is

• **CLIENT TO CONFIRM** ; in the prototype, capture and show a success state. Reuse the shared lead-form component.

7.4 · Upgrade page TEMPLATE (Solar = flagship) ✓

One reusable pattern, themed per upgrade. Solar is the richest instance and links to the C&I journey.

REUSABLE BLOCK PATTERN (EACH UPGRADE PAGE)

1. **Upgrade hero** — what it is + the headline benefit + eligibility CTA.
2. **How much you can get** — indicative value, framed "up to" .
3. **How it works for this upgrade** — short, links to full How It Works.
4. **Why us / full-chain** — the done-for-you promise in this context.
5. **Stacking note** — which incentives combine for this upgrade.
6. **FAQ (upgrade-specific) + CTA.**

PER-UPGRADE STATUS

Solar ★ flagship — build first, richest, includes a residential vs commercial split and a link into the Business page. ✓

Heat Pumps, Hot Water, Battery, Air Con, LED — same template. Which ship in the v1 prototype vs stubbed is

◆ **DEV'S DISCRETION by effort**

; at minimum build the template + Solar + 1–2 others so the pattern is proven. Any upgrade can be added/removed independently.

7.5 · Business / C&I ✓ LOCKED — separate journey

Gap ⑧. Rational, ROI-driven, credibility-first. Distinct tone from residential.

SECTION BLOCKS

1. **Business hero** — credibility + scale framing (commercial solar can mean six-figure value). CTA: *Book a site assessment* (higher-intent than the residential primary).
2. **The commercial opportunity** — what C&I solar / upgrades can deliver, ROI-oriented.
3. **How it works for business** — including the longer measurement & verification path and what to expect.
4. **Full-chain for business** — we manage the whole project; compliance handled.
5. **Accreditation & compliance** — heavier emphasis here; businesses care about it.
6. **Case studies / logos** • client to supply + CTA.

NOTES

Tone is the differentiator: most competitors that address business do it dryly. Be credible *and* clear. May reuse a business-tuned variant of the eligibility checker.

7.6 · About / Why Us ✓

Gaps ③ ⑤ — accreditation as evidenced proof, and the full-chain story.

SECTION BLOCKS

1. **Who we are** — the accredited, full-chain positioning.
2. **Accreditation as proof** — official badges • + the annual fit-and-proper / competent-and-capable testing fact (no competitor uses this).
3. **The full-chain advantage** — why owning lead → install → certificate protects the customer.
4. **Trust signals** — reviews, partners, longevity of the program.
5. CTA.

7.7 · FAQ ✓

Where "answer every question" lives. Starter content below — factually grounded.

PRE-ANSWERED STARTER QUESTIONS (EXPAND WITH CLIENT)

- **Is it means-tested?** The VEU program is not means-tested — open to Victorian households and businesses. (Solar Victoria components may have income thresholds — keep distinct.)
- **Can I claim more than once?** Yes — for different qualifying upgrades.
- **Do I need a special provider?** Yes — only an accredited person can create the certificates. (That's us.)
- **Is this "free"?** No — there are no free upgrades; a minimum contribution applies. Here's what you'll actually pay. (Honest framing — compliance.)
- **Who sets the rebate value?** The market — certificate prices move with supply and demand, not a fixed government rate.
- **What happens to my old appliance?** For some upgrades it's removed and responsibly recycled by us.
- **How long does it take?** Residential is fast; larger commercial projects run a longer verification path.

Implement as an accordion. Categorise (Residential / Business / Money & eligibility) as it grows.

7.8 · Contact · details

Simple, trustworthy, low-friction.

SECTION BLOCKS

1. Contact form (shared component)
2. Phone / email / service area  client to confirm
3. Trust strip reused in footer

Prototype: form captures and shows success; real destination wired at launch .

8 • Phase 2 / parked backlog ◆ DEFERRED

Deliberately not built in v1, but scoped enough to add later without a rebuild. When the owner or client greenlights any of these, it should be a small task, not a fresh project. Architect the relevant areas to accommodate them.

8.1 • Interactive stacking-savings calculator ◆ PHASE 2

Owner: "not sure yet — the client may like it." Parked, not dropped.

What it would do: let a user input their upgrade + situation and see an *indicative* combined value across VEU + Solar Victoria + STC. The v1 explainer section occupies the same slot — so leave that slot architected to swap an explainer for an interactive widget.

Why deferred: higher build effort; indicative figures are policy/market-sensitive and need client sign-off; value to the client is unconfirmed. **To enable later:** keep rebate figures in a single config/data source (not scattered in markup) so a calculator can consume them; keep the stacking section a self-contained module.

Other likely future requests (pre-noted so they're not a surprise)

- **CMS / self-editing** — currently dev-maintained by choice; revisit if edit volume grows.
- **Additional upgrade pages** — any not shipped in v1, added via the existing template.
- **Blog / resources** — for SEO; several competitors have one. Architect nav to allow it.
- **Booking integration** (e.g. calendar) for "book assessment."
- **Analytics & tracking** (GA4 / pixel)  — add at launch.
- **Multi-region** (e.g. NSW) — some competitors operate cross-state; keep content structure region-agnostic in case.

9 · Open items — client to confirm

Everything the prototype can proceed without, but that must be supplied/confirmed before launch. Use placeholders meanwhile. This is the checklist to close before go-live.

#	Item	Needed for	Prototype placeholder
1	Brand assets — logo, final colors, fonts	Visual identity (Section 5)	Tasteful neutral placeholders
2	Lead destination — CRM / email / booking tool	Eligibility, Contact, CTAs	Capture + success state
3	Contact details — phone, email, service area	Contact, footer, sticky bar	Dummy details
4	Indicative rebate figures — confirmed & compliant	Upgrade pages, stacking	"Up to / indicative" placeholders
5	Social proof — reviews, testimonials, client logos	Home, About, Business	Placeholder cards
6	Legal copy — Privacy, T&Cs	Legal pages	Lorem / standard template
7	Trading name & accreditation details to display	About, trust strips	Placeholder name
8	Tech-stack preference (if any)	Whole build	Developer's choice
9	Which upgrade pages ship in v1	Scope	Template + Solar + 1–2
10	Analytics / tracking IDs	Launch	Omit in prototype

Definition of done — prototype

All ✓ LOCKED pages built and navigable; self-select working; How It Works + eligibility checker ($\geq$ Tier A) + honest-cost framing present; visual direction proposed and chosen; modular/component structure in place; all  items using clear placeholders; Phase 2 slots architected (not built). The owner can then react section-by-section and the client can be walked through a real, clickable site.

End of PRD v1.0 · Built to evolve — change is expected, and the structure is designed to absorb it.